

Data Detective



BIG IDEA One clue is harmless. Many small clues put together can reveal who someone is and where to find them.

1 HOOK 2'

2 ACTIVITY 8'

3 DISCUSS 3'

4 TAKEAWAY 2'

PREP IN 5 MINUTES

Materials: Profile Cards (R-5.1: 18 cards, three fake kids), Detective Dossier (p. 14), Clue Clean-Up cards (R-5.2). Everyone is fictional.

- ☐ Shuffle one set of 18 cards per group.
- ☐ Copy the Dossier worksheet.
- ☐ Say it early: “These kids are not real. Any match to a real person is a coincidence.”

1 HOOK 2 MIN 60-second script “Detectives, put on your hats. I will tell you three small facts about a kid. Fact one: nine years old. Fact two: a dog named Biscuit. Fact three: plays on the Maple Hill soccer team, number 12. (Pause.) Do you know who it is? Not yet. Three facts are not enough. But what if I add more? The street she lives on. The time she gets off the bus. A picture of her front door. Suddenly a stranger could find her. Each clue was harmless. Together, they are a map. Today you are Data Detectives, so you can be Data Protectors too.”

2 ACTIVITY 8 MIN Crack the Case

- 1 (1 min) Meet three made-up kids:** Jordan, Mina and Eli. “Today we are Data PROTECTORS. Nobody is looking for a real kid.”
- 2 (4 min) Sort and build.** Sort 18 cards into three piles by kid (same dog, team or street). Fill three dossier rows: Where do they live? When and where could you find them? What could be a password guess?
- 3 (2 min) Reveal.** Read the answers; cheer for groups who found them.
- 4 (1 min) The turn.** Nobody posted the address in one post. You pieced it together: a data trail. We choose carefully and use the Clue Check.

3 DISCUSS 3 MIN

- 1** “Which clue surprised you the most?”
- 2** “Why can posts from different places be pieced together?”
- 3** “What if someone asks about your school, address or schedule?” (Pause, Check, Tell.)

4 TAKEAWAY 2 MIN “If a post gives away too much, you might feel hackles up. False alarms are fine, and it is never your fault. Clues add up. Before you share, do the Clue Check: ‘Could someone put these clues together to find me?’”

Hand signal: Hackles Up (hand brushed up the neck), Pause (palm), Check (magnifier fingers), Tell (hand on chest, then out).

EXIT TICKET “Write one thing that is safe to share and one thing that should stay private.”

FUN BOOST Detective Walk (30 seconds). Tiptoe in slow detective mode. At “Clue!” freeze and point to something that tells a visitor about our class. Even a classroom leaves clues!

LEVEL-UP Home Clue Hunt. With a grown-up, find the clues a stranger could see on a backpack, jersey or family photo. Make one fix together.

DIFFERENTIATE Give a hint sheet (“Look for the same dog, team or street”); use only two kids (12 cards).

FAMILY CARD Try the Clue Check before posting photos: does it show our address, school, plans or schedule?

IF A STUDENT TELLS YOU SOMETHING

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Say: “Thank you for telling me. You did the right thing.” • “This is not your fault, and you are not in trouble.” • “I can’t keep this a secret, because I need to get you help. I will tell you who I tell.” | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Do not say: “I promise I won’t tell anyone.” • “Are you sure?” or “Why didn’t you tell me sooner?” • Anything beyond “Can you tell me more?” |
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First 10 Minutes: see the Disclosure Guide.

Then: tell your counselor or designated person right away. Follow your school policy and your state’s reporting law.